1994: The BJP wins forty seats in the Karnataka state assembly, a jump from just four in 1989.

15 March 1994: L.K. Advani declares that the BJP is opposed to the jingoism on MNCs. Says 'if the BJP is to take its place in the Indian polity as a "modern party", it will have to articulate an economic policy that is taken seriously not merely in India but in the world'.

1994: The Gujarat government adds Hindu Modh Ghanchis to the OBC list, the Union government does so in 1999. These circulars mean Modi is legally classified as an OBC leader at forty-nine, halfway into his political career.

1996: The BJP emerges as the single-largest party in the Lok Sabha, with 160 seats. Atal Bihari Vajpayee sworn in as the party's first prime minister but his government falls in thirteen days.

1998: Vajpayee becomes prime minister again after winning a mandate as head of the BJP-led National Democratic Alliance.

- India conducts its second nuclear tests in Pokharan.

1998: The BJP wins a simple majority of Lok Sabha seats in Karnataka for the first time as part of an alliance with Ramakrishna Hegde's Lok Shakti.

1999: India fights the Kargil War with Pakistan; Vajpayee government falls after AIADMK withdraws support. Vajpayee returns to power for third time as PM, heading the NDA as the BJP wins its highest-ever Lok Sabha tally (till then) of 183.

25 September 1999: RSS starts its first 'cybershakha'. Cybershakha attendees:

- do not have to wear RSS uniforms,
- can approach the RSS supremo directly,
- women can 'send messages to the RSS chief'.

March 2000: RSS chief K.S. Sudarshan calls the PMO incompetent and laments that the BJP had become 'Congressised'.

April 2000: Senior RSS leader and SJM founder Dattopant Thengdi attacks Finance Minister Yashwant Sinha. RSS Joint General